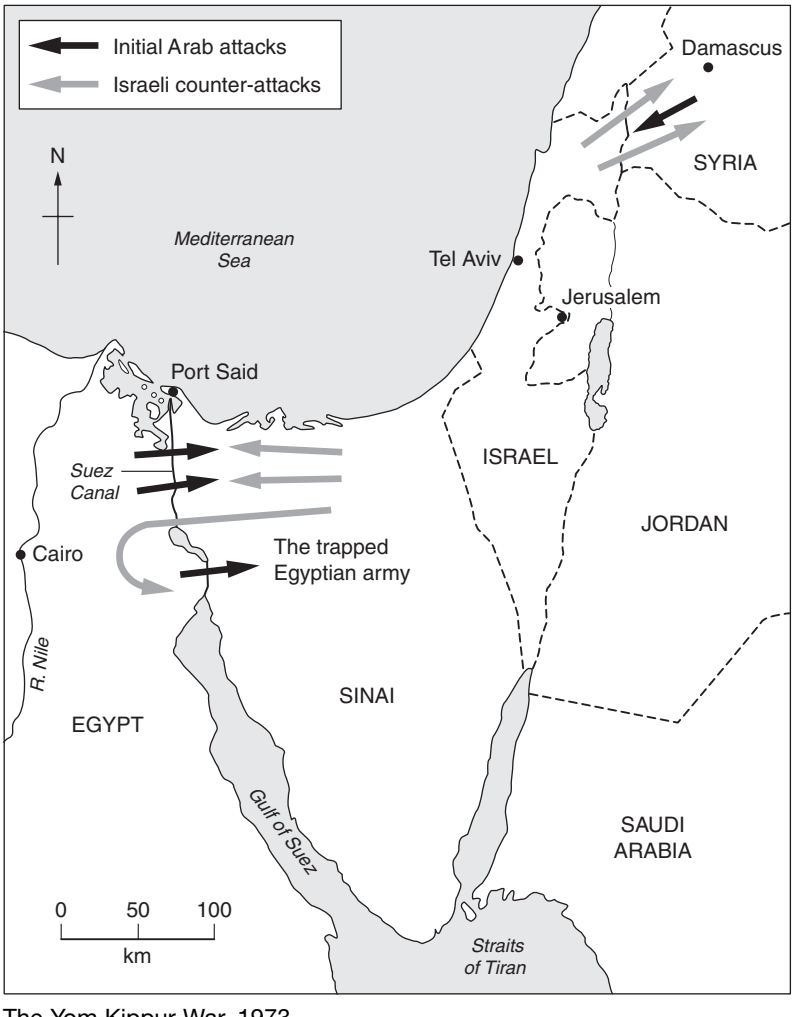


The Yom Kippur War, 1973.

Soviet surface-to-air missiles which they used very effectively. It took the Israeli army three days to become fully mobilised. However, by 12 October, they had pushed the Syrians back and, on 15 October, they thrust across the Suez Canal and cut off the Egyptian third army (see the above map).

Yom Kippur War: 6–24 October 1973

Key date

The oil weapon

With the Israelis threatening the Egyptian capital, Cairo, the Arabs produced an unexpected weapon – oil. The West received much of its oil from the Middle East. The Arab oil-producing states decided to reduce oil production until the Israelis withdrew from the lands they had occupied in 1967. The richest oil state, Saudi Arabia, went further. It banned all oil exports to the USA and to the Netherlands, which supplied much of Western Europe through the port of Rotterdam. The West was shocked.